issues, the discussion veered away from the LDC issues. The LDC issues include:

(i) duty free quota free (DFQF) market access;

(ii) the rules of origin for DFQF market access;

(iii) LDC waiver in services; and

(iv) issues relating to cotton (domestic and export subsidies for cotton and tariffs).

Some of the issues suggested in addition for an **'LDC plus'** package were trade facilitation and the export competition pillar of the agriculture negotiations. There was, however, little progress in arriving at a consensus on the elements of the early harvest package. The LDCs made it clear that if the LDC package was not delivered at the December 2011 Ministerial Conference, they would be very disappointed. The African Group, the African-Caribbean-Pacific Group, and other groups of developing countries supported an effort to harvest an LDC package for the Conference. India too, supported this stand.

In *October–November 2011*, concerted efforts were made by some of the developed country members of the WTO to use the G20 Leaders Summit in November 2011 to advance an agenda for the ***Eighth WTO Ministerial Conference*** scheduled to be held in **Geneva** in December 2011. Specifically, they wanted the following things:

(i) to set the stage for plurilateral agreements on selected issues in the WTO negotiations (rather than multilateral agreements);

(ii) to get WTO members' on abjuring the use of export restrictions; and

(iii) to introduce new issues for negotiation, namely climate change, energy security, and food security.

The weeks preceding the Eighth WTO Ministerial Conference saw hectic activity in the WTO as some members attempted to put various issues on the agenda for ministerial decision. These proposals, however, did not receive support amongst WTO members. At the ***Eighth Ministerial Conference*** from 15 to 17 December 2011, ministers adopted a number of decisions on intellectual property (IP), electronic commerce, small economies, LDCs' accession, a services waiver for LDCs, and trade policy reviews.